Timeline of Some Work of Michel Foucault

Scott with DuckAI

Contents

- **madness and confinement** are central in the early 1960s;
- **knowledge and the limits of thought** in the mid-to-late 1960s;
- **panopticism and disciplinary surveillance** most explicitly in 1975; and
- **broader power over populations** in his later work.

Date	Work or period	Connection to your topics
1961	*History of Madness* (often published in English as *Madness and Civilization*)	Examines how European institutions and ideas separated madness from reason, confined people deemed mad, and helped shape the modern idea of mental illness.
1966–69	*The Order of Things* (1966); *The Archaeology of Knowledge* (1969)	Studies how historical systems of knowledge shape what can be thought and treated as true. The limits that a society's accepted knowledge puts on thinking.
1975	*Discipline and Punish*	Foucault analyzes the modern prison and disciplinary power. He uses **Jeremy Bentham's Panopticon**—a prison design—as a model for how the possibility of being watched can encourage people to regulate their own behavior. He extends the analysis beyond prisons to institutions and society.
1976 onward	*The History of Sexuality*, starting with Volume 1, *The Will to Knowledge*	Develops his analysis of power beyond the prison, including how institutions and practices manage populations and shape conduct. This can inform discussions of state surveillance."
1980s and later reception	Late interviews and lectures; later interpretations of his work	Foucault is often grouped with "postmodern" thinkers, but he did not straightforwardly identify himself as a postmodernist; he was associated with post-structuralism and was skeptical of the vague term "postmodernity."